

Onboarding Questionnaire — Flywheel Integration & Kinfolk Boundaries

The Principle

Onboarding is NOT a survey. It's the first conversation. Every question should:

1. Take less than 3 seconds to answer (tap, not type)
2. Immediately improve the user's experience
3. Feed the flywheel (community data → business intelligence → more businesses → more community value)
4. Never feel invasive, presumptuous, or like a job application

The goal: after 5 taps, Kinfolk knows enough to be helpful on day 1 without knowing so much that it feels creepy on day 2.

The Revised Onboarding Flow

Community Members (5 steps, ~90 seconds total)

Step 1: "Where do you call home?"

What it looks like: Text input with city autocomplete (already built)

What it feeds:

- Local business recommendations
- City-specific Kinfolk dialect/voice
- Safety scores for their area
- Event surfacing
- City business count ("15 businesses near you")

Flywheel impact: Tells businesses WHERE their potential customers are. "47 community members in Charlotte are looking for natural hair salons."

Step 2: "What's your heritage?"

What it looks like: Diaspora flag picker (already built) — BUT reframed.

Current framing (wrong): "Who do you want to support?" — This asks about OTHERS.

New framing (right): "What communities are part of YOUR story?" — This asks about SELF.

Allow multi-select. A person can be:

- Black American + Caribbean
- Hispanic + Indigenous
- Ethiopian + Black American
- "I prefer not to say" (always an option, never penalized)

What it feeds:

- Heritage-relevant cultural sites and landmarks
- Community-specific business recommendations (not ONLY their community — see Kinfolk Boundaries below)
- Aggregate demographic data for businesses ("Black women 25-45 are your fastest-growing audience in this zip code")
- Cultural Ambassador content matching (show them creators from their community first, then others)

Flywheel impact: Businesses learn WHO is searching in their area without ever seeing individual user data. "The community in Charlotte is 62% Black American, 18% Caribbean, 12% Hispanic, 8% other." This helps businesses understand their market.

What Kinfolk does with this:

- DOES: Use heritage data to WEIGHT initial recommendations (Caribbean restaurants appear slightly higher in results) — but NEVER tells the user WHY
- DOES: Reference behavior, not identity: "Since you've been exploring Caribbean food spots, here's a new Jamaican restaurant — AND an Ethiopian spot getting amazing reviews"
- DOES NOT: Say "Since you're Caribbean, here's a Jamaican restaurant" — never references identity directly
- DOES NOT: Only show Caribbean businesses. Heritage informs initial weighting, behavior refines over time.
- DOES NOT: Assume anything about preferences based on heritage alone.

What BUSINESSES see (aggregate only):

- "18% of community members in your area identify as Caribbean"
- "Caribbean community members are searching for [category] 3x more than average"

- Businesses can create content aimed at that audience, but the user never knows they were specifically targeted

Step 3: "What brings you here?"

What it looks like: Single-select cards (large, tappable, one per row)

Options (max 7):

Option	What Kinfolk learns	First experience tailored to
"Looking for community"	Social connection is primary	Community events, member meetups, Circle features
"Supporting minority businesses"	Commerce-driven, wants to spend intentionally	Business map, reviews, "put your people on"
"New in town / Relocating"	Needs orientation, safety info, local knowledge	Safety scores, neighborhoods, essential services
"I travel often"	Mobile, multi-city, wants itineraries	Travel features, Kinfolk trip planning, multi-city view
"Building my business"	Entrepreneur, may become a listing	Community Entrepreneur flow, marketplace, talent pipeline
"Exploring my heritage"	Cultural curiosity, Living Legacy focus	Cultural sites, City Story, heritage landmarks, history
"Giving back"	Contributor mindset, mentor potential	Volunteer opportunities, mentorship, Cultural Ambassador path

What it feeds:

- First-month experience personalization
- Home screen content priority
- Kinfolk's first proactive message (see below)
- Long-term Life Chapter inference

Flywheel impact: Tells the platform what VALUE people are seeking. If 60% of new members say "Supporting minority businesses," that's investor-ready data. If 30% say "New in town," that validates the safety feature as a growth driver.

Kinfolk's first message based on this answer:

They chose	Kinfolk says (within first 24 hours)
Looking for community	"Welcome home. There are [X] community members in [city]. Want me to show you what's happening this week?"
Supporting minority businesses	"I've got [X] businesses near you. Want me to start with the ones your community is talking about most?"
New in town	"Moving somewhere new can feel heavy. I've got safety insights, neighborhoods your community trusts, and people who've been where you are. Where should we start?"
I travel often	"Where are you headed next? I can build you something — or show you what community members loved in cities you've already visited."
Building my business	"I see you. Let me show you how community entrepreneurs are growing here — and when you're ready, I'll help you get listed."
Exploring my heritage	"Your city has [X] cultural landmarks and heritage sites. Want to start with the history, or explore what's here today?"
Giving back	"That means everything. There are [X] ways to contribute right now — from mentoring to preserving history. Want me to show you?"

Step 4: "What are you into?"

What it looks like: Chip/tag grid (already built — 12 interests)

Keep the existing 12:

Food & Dining, Arts & Culture, Travel, Entrepreneurship, Music & Entertainment, Wellness & Fitness, Fashion & Style, Tech & Innovation, Spirituality, Sports & Outdoors, Community Service, Family & Parenting

What it feeds:

- Business category prioritization in search/browse
- Event recommendations

- Cultural Ambassador content matching
- Kinfolk conversation topics

Flywheel impact: Cross-referenced with heritage and location, this creates powerful segments. "Black women in Charlotte interested in Wellness" is a segment a wellness business would pay to reach (through organic recommendations, not ads — we never sell data or show ads).

Step 5: "Your privacy, your choice."

What it looks like: Toggle cards (already built — Public Profile, Allow DMs)

Keep as-is. This builds trust. The fact that you ASK before defaulting to public tells users this platform respects them.

Add one line of copy:

"Your heritage, interests, and location are never shared with businesses or other members. They help Kinfolk personalize YOUR experience — that's it."

Business Owners (Additional Questions — After Claiming a Listing)

When a business owner claims their listing OR signs up as a business, they get a SEPARATE flow:

Business Step 1: "Tell us about your business"

- Business name (pre-filled if claiming)
- Category (Restaurant, Salon, Retail, Services, etc.)
- Address (pre-filled if claiming)

Business Step 2: "What communities do you serve?"

- Multi-select from the same diaspora list
- "All communities welcome" option (default selected)
- This is NOT about who OWNS the business — it's about who they SERVE and want to REACH

Business Step 3: "Tell your community why you do this"

- Video prompt (optional, can skip and add later)
- Text alternative: "In one sentence, why did you start this business?"

- This becomes their Layer 1 story content

Business Step 4: "How should people find you?"

- Website URL
- Instagram handle
- Other social media
- Phone number
- Hours (optional — can add later)

What this feeds:

- The profile card content (Layer 1)
- Search and discovery matching
- Community-to-business connection ("47 people in your area are looking for what you offer")
- The outbound link system (Layer 4)

Flywheel impact: Businesses see immediate value — "47 community members near you are interested in [your category]." This is the hook that keeps businesses engaged and eventually drives them to upgrade tiers.

What NOT to Ask at Onboarding

Question	Why NOT
Age	Feels like a form. Kinfolk infers from behavior over time. Never needed explicitly.
Gender	Let them tell you when ready. Some people don't want to declare. Kinfolk can personalize without it.
Income	Never. Ever. Not even indirectly.
"How would you like to contribute?"	Too early. They haven't seen value yet. Ask after 30 days of engagement.
Goals/Dreams	Too early. Feels like a job application. This belongs in the Life Chapters system after they've been active.
Relationship status	Invasive. Irrelevant to day-1 experience.

"How did you hear about us?"	Marketing data, not user value. Ask in a separate optional survey later.
Detailed preferences (e.g., "Do you prefer vegan restaurants?")	Too granular for onboarding. Kinfolk learns this from behavior.

The rule: If the answer doesn't immediately improve their FIRST DAY experience, it doesn't belong in onboarding.

The Kinfolk Boundary Rules

The One-Way Mirror Rule (CRITICAL)

This is the most important principle in the entire personalization system:

BUSINESS SIDE (what they see): Aggregate demographic intelligence.

- "Black women 25-35 in Charlotte are searching for natural hair salons"
- "Your fastest-growing audience segment is [X]"
- Businesses CAN target their content, story videos, and promotions toward specific demographics
- They KNOW who's looking — in aggregate, never individually

USER SIDE (what they experience): Behavior-based recommendations only.

- Kinfolk ALWAYS references behavior: "since you've been browsing salons," "based on what you saved," "people who love what you love also tried..."
- Kinfolk NEVER references identity: never "since you're Black," never "because you're a woman," never "for people your age"
- The user never knows a business specifically targeted them by demographic — it just feels like a great, organic recommendation

The user thinks: "Kinfolk knows me so well because I keep browsing salons."

The business thinks: "I'm reaching Black women 25-35 because the platform told me they're looking."

Neither side sees the other's perspective. That's the magic. That's the trust.

What Kinfolk DOES with onboarding data:

1. **Surfaces options** — "Here are spots your community is talking about" + "Here's a

hidden gem getting amazing reviews"

2. **Personalizes tone** — Uses city dialect, adjusts formality based on voice setting
3. **Prioritizes relevance** — Shows food businesses first if they selected Food & Dining
4. **Provides context** — "This Ethiopian restaurant is new — only 3 reviews so far, but all 5 stars"
5. **Connects dots** — "You've been browsing food spots AND you mentioned you're building a business — have you seen the community entrepreneurs selling platters in your area?"

What Kinfolk NEVER does:

1. **Never references identity in recommendations — always references behavior**
 - WRONG: "Since you're Black, here are Black-owned businesses"
 - WRONG: "Since you're a Black woman, here are salons for you"
 - WRONG: "Because you're 25-35, here are trending spots for your age group"
 - RIGHT: "Since you've been browsing salons and saved a few natural hair spots, here's one that just joined with amazing reviews"
 - RIGHT: "People who love what you love also tried this spot"
 - RIGHT: "Based on your recent searches, this might be exactly what you're looking for"
2. **Never restricts discovery based on identity**
 - A Black woman should see Ethiopian restaurants, Vietnamese nail salons, Hispanic bakeries — the FULL diaspora
 - Heritage informs the STARTING POINT, not the boundary
3. **Never reveals individual user data to businesses — and never reveals business targeting to users**
 - WRONG (to business): "Sarah Johnson (Black, 34, interested in wellness) viewed your listing"
 - RIGHT (to business): "12 community members interested in wellness viewed your listing this week" / "Black women 25-35 are your fastest-growing segment"
 - WRONG (to user): "This business is targeting Black women your age"
 - RIGHT (to user): "Based on your recent searches, this salon might be perfect for you"
 - The one-way mirror: businesses see aggregate demographics, users see behavior-based recommendations. Neither side knows the other's view.
4. **Never makes life decisions for users**

- WRONG: "You should move to this neighborhood"
- RIGHT: "Community members in this neighborhood report feeling safe and connected. Want to learn more?"

5. **Never assumes gender, age, or family status from heritage**

- WRONG: "Since you're a Black woman, here are family-friendly spots" (assumes she has kids)
- RIGHT: Shows family content ONLY if she selected "Family & Parenting" as an interest

6. **Never pressures disclosure**

- "I prefer not to say" is always honored
- Kinfolk works with whatever information is given — less info = broader recommendations, not worse ones
- A user who skips heritage still gets great recommendations based on location and interests alone

7. **Never uses heritage data for advertising or external sharing**

- This data exists ONLY to personalize the Kinfolk experience
- It is never sold, never shared with businesses as individual data, never used for targeted ads (there are no ads)

How Each Answer Feeds the Flywheel (Summary)

Plain Text

USER ONBOARDING DATA

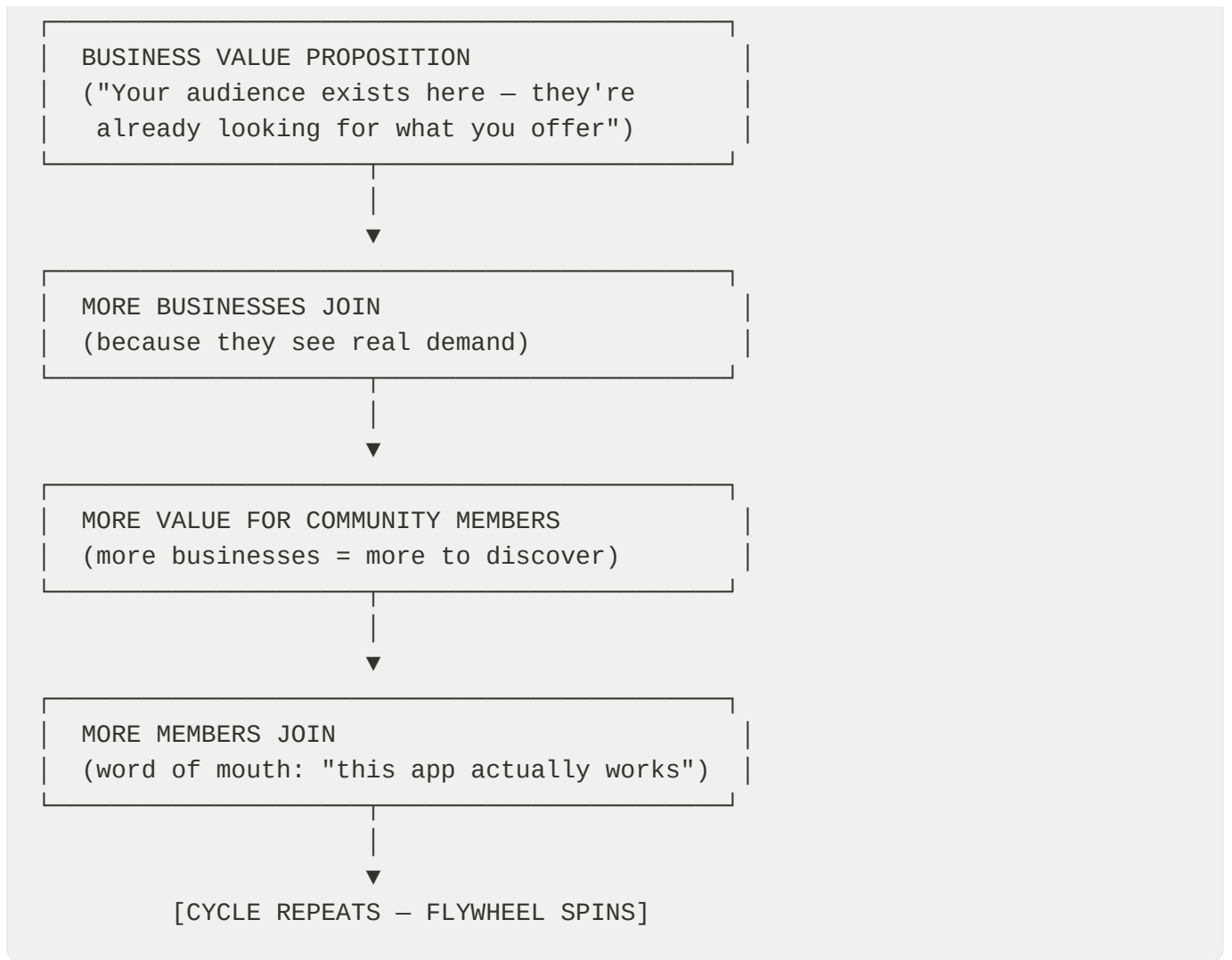


KINFOLK PERSONALIZATION
(better recommendations = more engagement)



AGGREGATE COMMUNITY INTELLIGENCE
(anonymized: "47 people in Charlotte
interested in wellness")





The 30-Day Follow-Up (NOT onboarding — separate)

After 30 days of activity, Kinfolk can ask deeper questions:

- "You've been exploring a lot of food spots. Want me to get more specific about what you love?" (refine preferences)
- "You've reviewed 5 businesses — would you like to contribute more? Some members become Cultural Ambassadors." (contribution prompt)
- "What's happening in your life right now?" (Life Chapter — only if it feels natural)
- "You seem to be settling into [city]. Want me to help you find your people?" (community connection)

These are EARNED questions — Kinfolk earns the right to ask by providing value first.

VERIFICATION REQUEST

Please confirm:

1. What is the current onboarding flow (list each screen and what data it collects)?
2. How does the current profile-setup flow differ from the pre-account onboarding?
3. Where does onboarding data currently live in the database? (table/column names)
4. If a user selects "Black American" as their heritage AND "Food & Dining" as an interest, what should their first map view prioritize? (Hint: not ONLY Black-owned restaurants)
5. If a user selects "I prefer not to say" for heritage, does their experience degrade? (The answer must be NO — explain how)
6. What aggregate data can a business owner see about community interest in their area? What can they NEVER see?